

basic, personal freedom. It is not a physically absolute freedom. If each of us were absolutely free to do whatever he wanted to do, we would have chaos instead of civilization. Peace of mind includes going along with the laws and customs of our times and our society. It also includes a balanced view toward any temporary loss of freedom.

A little while ago I suffered a temporary loss of liberty to get about as I wish. A light case of influenza sneaked past my Prince of Sound Physical Health and sent me to bed for three days. I could have fretted about the appointments I had to cancel; but if I had, my mind would have lost its liberty. Instead, I devoted the time to peacefully and restfully outlining this book. It had been a task which I had been "getting around to" for a long time. Once again I proved the soundness of the principle that *every adversity carries within it the seed of an equivalent or greater benefit.*

The concept of *time* is closely allied to the concept of *freedom*. Time is wealth, and unlike money when it is gone you cannot replace it. Many a man who arrives promptly for an appointment only to be kept waiting—or who is stuck in a traffic jam—gets into a stew over this infringement of his right to spend his time as he wishes to spend it. I have pointed out to salesmen that time spent in an anteroom can be time spent in reviewing one's sales pointers and thus be the better prepared for selling—or, in many cases, the time may be spent in observing and listening so that one gathers useful information about the customer's needs. For a salesman or anyone else, enforced waiting time can be transmuted into a time of quiet relaxation which restores the strength of mind and body. Even a driver in a traffic jam can keep his mind peaceful and thoughtful, and it is often on such occasions, while one is alert but not heavily concentrating, that the subconscious mind feeds back the answers to questions and problems which may have lain within it a long time.

Peace of mind is a many-splendored thing. Now connect it with the statement you read a moment ago: *Time is wealth, and unlike money when it is gone you cannot replace it.* Peace of mind is so beneficial to your entire well-being, however, that it is almost certain to extend your life and to help you keep active and productive far into your later years—so that "lost" time *can* in a sense be replaced, and at a most valuable period.

Liberty includes peace of mind; peace of mind is a basic liberty. We have too many slaves to the clock, too many